Holden Holden FE / FC / FB / EK (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/2

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Holden | Model: Holden FE / FC / FB / EK | Australian Market Years: 1956-1962
Vehicle Type: Sedan / Station Sedan / Utility / Panel Van | Segment: Large | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Fishermans Bend, Victoria, Dandenong, Victoria, Woodville, South Australia, Pagewoo

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The second and third generation post-war Holdens represented major leaps forward in Australian automotive engineering and design. Launched in July 1956, the FE introduced a completely modern , longer, lower body with wrap-around windscreen, 12-volt electrical architecture, recirculatin g ball steering, and Holden's very first factory station wagon?marketed as the 'Station Sedan'. The May 1958 FC refined the formula with an egg-crate grille and became the first car in Austr alian history to sell over 100,000 units in a calendar year. In January 1960, the FB adopted Am erican fin-tail styling and a larger 138ci Grey motor, followed in May 1961 by the EK, which br ought the historic introduction of the 3-speed Hydra-Matic automatic transmission to Holden. Ac ross all four series, over 740,000 vehicles were built.

The FE-EK era cemented Holden's absolute supremacy in Australian motoring, securing over 50% to tal market share. The Station Sedan revolutionized family holidays and outback travel, while th e EK Hydra-Matic made two-pedal driving accessible to middle Australia. The Dandenong (Victoria) assembly plant opened during the FE era to meet soaring national demand, while exports expand ed across 46 overseas markets throughout Africa, Southeast Asia, and the Pacific.

SERIES / GENERATION: FE (FE Series) [1956-1958]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None
First clean-sheet redesign of the Holden. Introduced 12-volt electrics, wrap-around windscreen, pendant clutch and brake pedals, and the first factory Station Sedan.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Grey-132-FE: 2.16L (2160cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 52.0 kW / 149.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- FE Special Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $1840-$1960, Fuel=9.8L/100km
- FE Special Station Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $1990-$2120, Fuel=10.2L/10

Factory Configurations:

* FE Special Sedan | Sedan | Grey-132-FE | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 52.0kW/149.0Nm
* FE Special Station Sedan | Station Sedan | Grey-132-FE | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 52.0kW/149.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: FC (FC Series) [1958-1960]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None
Refinement of the FE with bold egg-crate grille, revised chrome fins, improved steering gear, a nd increased 72 bhp power output. Over 191,000 produced.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Grey-132-FC: 2.16L (2160cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 54.0 kW / 149.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- FC Special Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $1890-$2010, Fuel=9.7L/100km
- FC Special Station Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $2040-$2180, Fuel=10.1L/10

Factory Configurations:

* FC Special Sedan | Sedan | Grey-132-FC | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 54.0kW/149.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: FB (FB Series) [1960-1961]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None

Introduced prominent American-style tailfins, panoramic wrap-around windscreen with forward-sla
nted ’dogleg’ A-pillars, lower roofline, and an enlarged 138ci Grey motor.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Grey-138-FB: 2.26L (2262cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 56.0 kW / 163.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- FB Special Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $1950-$2080, Fuel=10.0L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* FB Special Sedan | Sedan | Grey-138-FB | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 56.0kW/163.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: EK (EK Series) [1961-1962]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None

Historic introduction of Holden’s first automatic transmission: the 3-speed Hydra-Matic. Added
electric windscreen wipers, updated side chrome, and new interior trim. 150,214 built.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Grey-138-EK: 2.26L (2262cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 56.0 kW / 163.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- EK Special Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, 3-speed Hydra-Matic automatic, AUD $19
- EK Special Station Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, 3-speed Hydra-Matic automatic,

Factory Configurations:

* EK Special Sedan | Sedan | Grey-138-EK | 3-speed Hydra-Matic automatic | RWD | 56.0kW/163.0Nm
* EK Special Station Sedan | Station Sedan | Grey-138-EK | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 56.0kW/163.0Nm